

home buyer

ScottGerami.com

RENTING VS. BUYING

The No-Pressure Guide for Renters

THE PRESSURE • ALL THE FACTS YOU NEED, WITHOUT THE PRESSURE • ALL THE FACTS YOU NEED, WITHOUT



prepared by
Scott Gerami
YOUR NAPERVILLE REALTOR®



LET'S TALK DETAILS

rent or buy?

If you're reading this guide, you're probably asking yourself: ***"Is now the right time for me to buy a house?"***

I'm **[Agent Name]**, and I've helped hundreds of people just like you make this exact decision.

This guide isn't about pushing you to buy - it's about helping you make the right choice for your future.

In the next few pages, you'll discover:

- The true cost of renting vs. buying
- How to know if you're really ready
- Simple steps to prepare for homeownership
- What to do if you're concerned about the market

Making the jump from renting to owning is one of life's biggest financial decisions. You deserve to have all the information you need to make the right choice for your future. Let's explore if homeownership is your next step!

THE TRUE COST OF RENTING

Breaking Down the *Numbers That Matter*



YOUR MONTHLY RENT IS MORE THAN JUST A PAYMENT

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \$2,000 & \times & 12 & = & \$24,000 \\ \text{Monthly Rent} & & \text{Months} & & \text{Per Year} \end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \$24,000 & \times & 5 & = & \$120,000 \\ \text{Per Year} & & \text{Years} & & \text{PAID IN RENT} \end{array}$$

WHERE YOUR MONEY REALLY GOES

EVERY \$2,000 RENT PAYMENT :

- ☐ Landlord's Mortgage: \$1,000
- ☐ Property Taxes: \$300
- ☐ Maintenance: \$200
- ☐ Landlord's Wealth: \$500



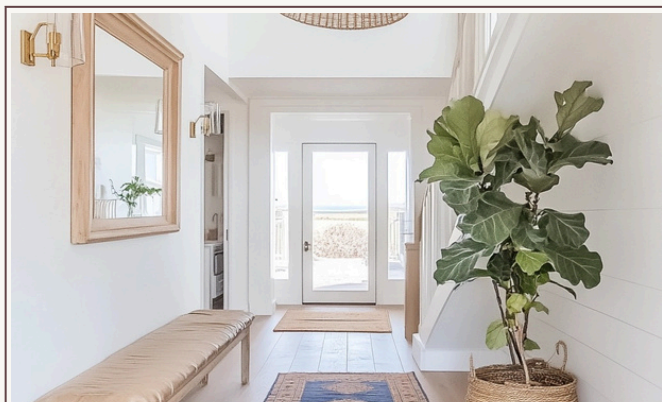


THE HARD TRUTH ABOUT RENTING



What You Get

- A place to live
- No maintenance responsibility
- Flexibility to move



What Your Landlord Gets

- Mortgage paid down
- Tax benefits
- Property appreciation
- Your money building their wealth



Over 5 years, your \$120,000 in rent payments could have built \$40,000+ in equity in your own home!



THE COST OF WAITING

Time is Money in *Today's Market*

RIISING HOME PRICES: A REAL EXAMPLE

\$400,000 HOME TODAY

- ☐ Down Payment (5%): \$20,000
- ☐ Monthly Payment: \$2,528*
- ☐ Annual Payment: \$30,336

SAME HOME NEXT YEAR *(6% appreciation)*

- ☒ New Price: \$424,000
- ☒ Down Payment (5%): \$21,200
- ☒ Monthly Payment: \$2,680*
- ☒ Annual Payment: \$32,160



| *PRINCIPAL AND INTEREST ONLY AT 6.5% INTEREST RATE*



WHAT WAITING ONE YEAR REALLY COSTS

EXTRA COSTS :

- ☐ \$1,200 More Down Payment
- ☐ \$152 More Monthly
- ☐ \$1,824 More Annually
- ☐ \$54,720 More Over 30 Years

THE DOUBLE IMPACT

WHILE YOU WAIT:

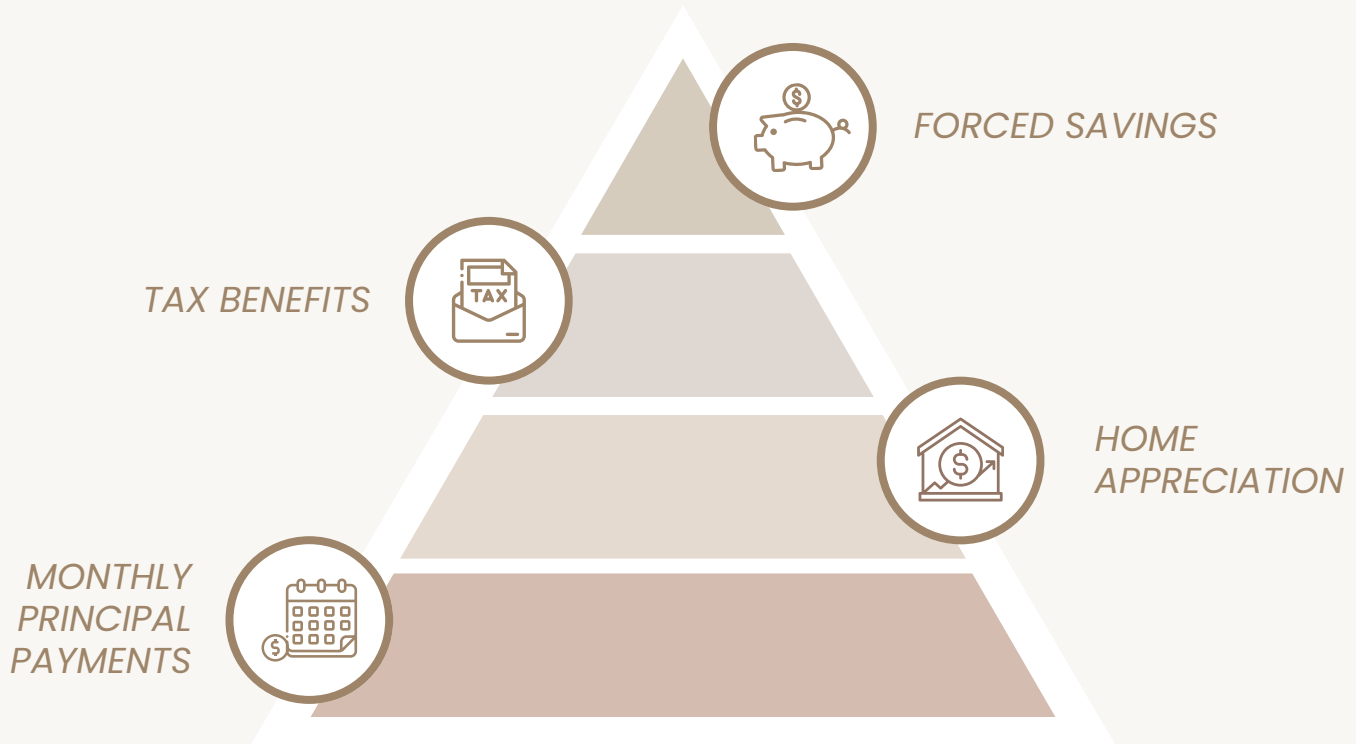
1. Home prices continue rising
2. You miss out on appreciation
3. Rent payments build no equity
4. Interest rates may increase



Waiting to buy doesn't just cost more money - it's missing out on building your own wealth

SMALL STEPS TO BIG WEALTH

How Homeownership *Builds Wealth*

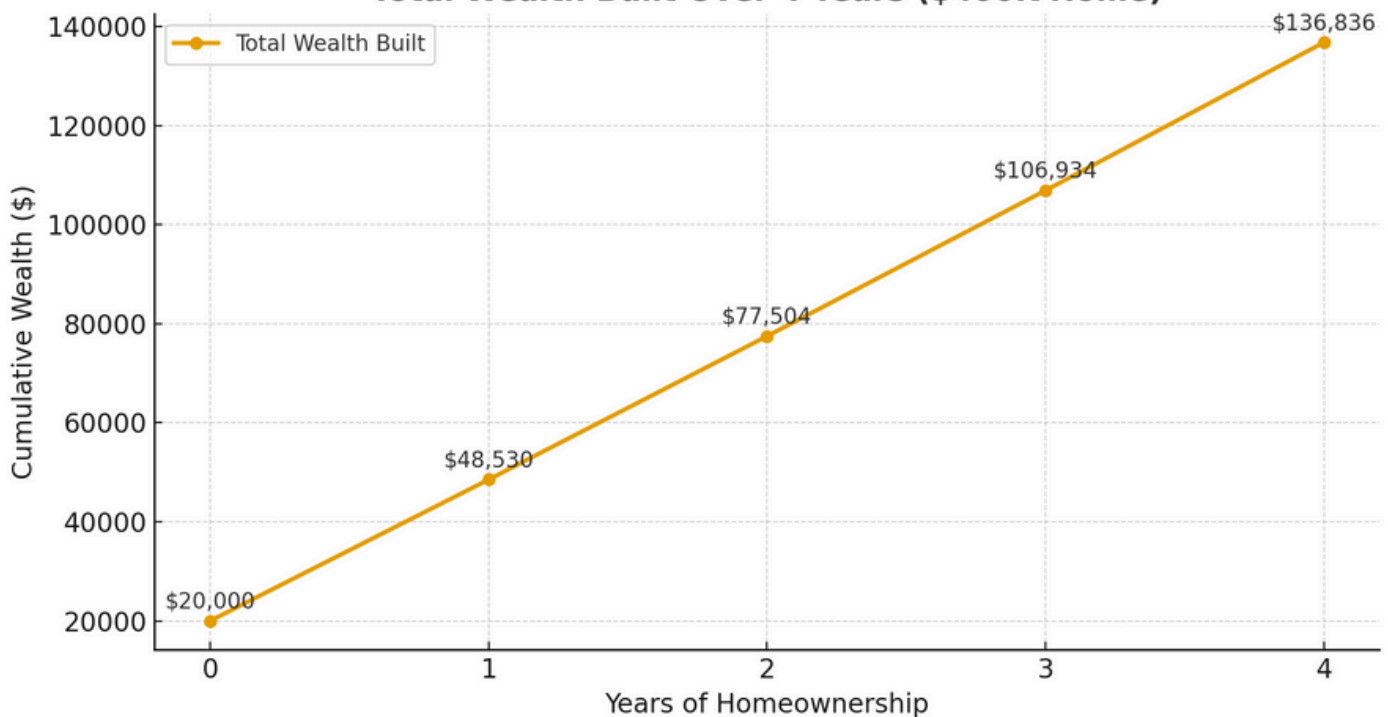


1. Monthly Principal Payments	3. Tax Benefits
◦ Each payment reduces your loan ◦ Builds equity automatically ◦ Fixed payment won't increase	◦ Mortgage interest deduction ◦ Property tax deduction ◦ Home office deductions
2. Home Appreciation	4. Forced Savings
◦ Average 3-5% yearly ◦ Completely passive growth ◦ Tax-free up to \$250,000 (single)/\$500,000 (married)	◦ Built-in financial discipline ◦ Systematic equity growth ◦ Protection against spending temptation

SMALL STEPS TO BIG WEALTH

How Homeownership *Builds Wealth*

Total Wealth Built Over 4 Years (\$400K Home)



STARTING WITH A \$400,000 HOME

- a. Down Payment: \$20,000
- b. Equity from Payments: \$40,000
- c. Appreciation (3% yearly): \$61,836
- d Tax Benefits: \$15,000+ = Total Wealth Built: \$116,836+



Are You Ready To *Be A Homeowner?*

KEY QUESTIONS TO CONSIDER

FINANCIAL READINESS

ABOUT YOUR INCOME	YES	NO
• Have you been at your job for 2+ years?		
• Is your income stable or growing?		
• Do you have consistent employment history?		
ABOUT YOUR SAVINGS		
• Have you saved at least 3-5% for a down payment?		
• Do you have 3+ months of emergency savings?		
• Can you cover moving and closing costs?		
ABOUT YOUR CREDIT		
• Do you know your current credit score?		
• Have you checked your credit report recently?		
• Have you paid bills on time for the past year?		



LIFESTYLE QUESTIONS

LOCATION & STABILITY	YES	NO
• Do you plan to stay in the area for 3+ years?		
• Are you established in your career here?		
• Does this location match your long-term goals?		
PERSONAL READINESS		
• Are you willing to handle home maintenance?		
• Do you want more control over your living space?		
• Are you ready for a long-term investment?		

SCORE YOUR ANSWER

- ☐ **13-15 Yes** = *You're ready! Let's talk about getting started*
- ☐ **10-12 Yes** = *Very close! A few small steps to prepare*
- ☐ **7-9 Yes** = *On the right track. Let's make a 6-month plan*
- ☐ **4-6 Yes** = *Getting there. Let's make a 12-month plan*
- ☐ **0-3 Yes** = *Let's build your path to homeownership*

BREAKING DOWN THE MYTHS

Truth vs. Fiction in *Home Buying*

✗ MYTH

"20% DOWN
PAYMENT REQUIRED"



REALITY

MANY BUYERS PUT
3-5% DOWN

- FHA loans: 3.5% down
- Conventional: 3-5% down
- VA loans: 0% down
- Down payment assistance available



MYTH

"PERFECT CREDIT
REQUIRED"



REALITY

VARIOUS OPTIONS
AVAILABLE

- FHA loans from 580+
- Conventional from 620+
- Focus on recent history
- Improvement plans welcome

✗ MYTH

"MUST BE DEBT-
FREE"



REALITY

IT'S ABOUT
MANAGEMENT

- Debt-to-income ratio matters
- Student loans okay
- Credit cards manageable
- Car payments acceptable



MYTH

"I NEED TO MAKE SIX
FIGURES"



REALITY

IT'S ABOUT
STABILITY

- Consistent employment matters more
- Part-time income counts
- Self-employed can qualify
- Multiple income sources accepted



MYTH

"I SHOULD WAIT FOR
PRICES TO DROP"



REALITY

BUY WHEN
YOU'RE READY

- Can't time the market perfectly
- Prices historically trend up
- Building equity beats waiting
- Rent costs while waiting

YOUR 5-STEP SUCCESS PLAN

Getting Ready for *Homeownership*

STEP 1

KNOW YOUR NUMBERS

CREDIT SCORE ACTION ITEMS

- Pull your free report
- Dispute any errors
- Pay bills on time
- Keep credit use low



STEP 2

BUILD YOUR SAVINGS

SMART SAVING STRATEGIES

- Set automatic transfers
- Track spending
- Reduce unnecessary expenses
- Save tax refunds
- Consider side income



STEP 3

GET PRE-APPROVED

WHY PRE-APPROVAL MATTERS

- Know true budget
- Stronger offers
- Faster closing
- Better rates
- Seller confidence



STEP 4

DEFINE YOUR MUST-HAVES

ESSENTIAL CATEGORIES

- Location priorities
- Size requirements
- Style preferences
- Must-have features
- Deal breakers



STEP 3

BUILD YOUR TEAM

KEY PLAYERS

- Trusted lender
- **Experienced agent**
- Home inspector
- Real estate attorney
- Insurance agent



Don't worry about this step! I will take care of all of this for you!

UNDERSTANDING TODAY'S MARKET

Making Smart Decisions

In Any Market

MARKET DYNAMICS

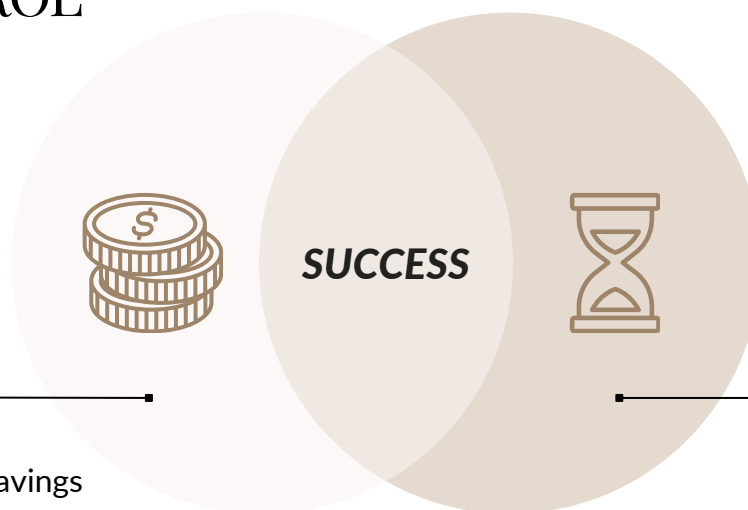
UNDERSTANDING SUPPLY & DEMAND

- Active listings shape competition
- Days on market indicate pace
- Local market trends matter
- Seasonal patterns affect pricing

WHY DO INTEREST RATES MATTER?

- Rates impact buying power
- Lower rates = lower payments
- Higher rates = adjusted budget
- Rate changes affect home prices

FOCUS ON WHAT YOU CAN CONTROL



FINANCIAL

- Down payment savings
- Credit score improvements
- Debt management
- Income stability

TIMELINE

- Personal readiness
- Market research
- Team building
- Property search

MY COMMITMENT TO YOU

Full Transparency *In Every Step*

WHAT TO EXPECT WORKING WITH ME

BEFORE YOUR SEARCH

Let's start with a personalized strategy session. We'll review your budget, explore loan options, and analyze current market conditions to create your custom home-buying plan. This preparation ensures you're ready to act when the right home appears.

DURING YOUR SEARCH

I'll be your dedicated guide through every property, providing detailed insights about each home and neighborhood. You'll get honest feedback about property condition, future value potential, and how each home aligns with your goals. No surprises - just clear, actionable information.

MAKING THE DEAL

When you find the right home, I'll handle all the complexities. From crafting a strong offer to negotiating terms, managing inspections, and coordinating with all parties - my role is to make your journey to closing day smooth and stress-free.



MY PROMISE

- ✓ Honest Communication
- ✓ No Pressure Decisions
- ✓ 24/7 Availability
- ✓ Expert Guidance
- ✓ Your Best Interests First

READY TO TAKE THE NEXT STEP?

Your Simple Path *Forward*



1. GET PRE-APPROVED

Know your true budget and strengthen your future offer

- Fast process
- Multiple lender options
- Clear budget picture

2. QUICK CHAT (15 MINUTES)

Let's discuss your goals and create your personalized plan

- No pressure
- Answer your questions
- Clear next steps

3. FIND YOUR HOME

I'll guide you through every step of the process

- Customized search
- Expert negotiations
- Smooth closing

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YEARS OF EXPERIENCE
HOMES SOLD
[X]% CLIENT SATISFACTION



CLIENT SUCCESS STORY

Working with Bentley
was the *best decision*
we made!



She made everything easy, breaking it down into simple steps. When we felt overwhelmed about [choosing neighborhoods/making an offer/pricing], she patiently guided us with deep market knowledge. The perfect mix of professional and personal—like a savvy friend in real estate!

SARAH & MARY ROGERS

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